It was believed that the 'India Shining' slogan of the outgoing government (i.e. the NDA) was correct but remained localised in its effects to the urban middle class only.[38] The new government seemed taking lessons from the past and tried to make India shine for the rural masses, too. Its one programme, the ***Bharat Nirman*** (a rural infrastructure focused programme), could be seen as a political attempt to make it happen.[39]

Only the coming times will tell as to what extent the Government has been able to educate the masses (better say the voters who vote!) the needful logic of the reforms.

DISINVESTMENT

Disinvestment is a process of selling government equities in public sector enterprises. Disinvestment in India is seen connected to three major inter-related areas, namely—

(i) A tool of public sector reforms[40]

(ii) A part of the economic reforms started mid-1991. It has to be done as a complementary part of the '***de-reservation of industries***'.[41]

(iii) Initially motivated by the need to raise resources for the budgetary allocations.[42]

The approach towards public sector reforms in India has been much more cautious than that of the other developing countries. India did not follow the radical solution to it—under which outright privatisation of commercially viable PSUs is done and of the unviable ones is completely closed.[43] There was an emphasis on increasing functional autonomy of public sector organisations to improve their efficiency in the 1980s in India as part of the public sector reforms. Once the process of economic reforms started in early 1990s, disinvestment became a part of the public sector reforms. The C. Rangarajan Commission on the Disinvestment of the Public Sector Enterprises (1991) went on to suggest the Government on the issue in a highly commendable and systematic way taking empirical notes from the experiences of disinvestment around the world. The government started the process of disinvestment in 1991 itself. In 1997 the Goverment did set up a